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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

DOWNTOWN DUBAI GEARS UP FOR NYE CELEBRATIONS

Arrangements are in place for New Year's Eve fireworks and celebrations in Downtown Dubai. While ticketed venues such as Burj Park offer premium views, there are also official free public viewing areas where visitors can enjoy the celebrations without paying an entry fee. LED screens along Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Boulevard will also show live fireworks, light shows and entertainment. **SEE ALSO P2, 3**

UAE ends counter-terrorism mission in Yemen citing safety

REJECTS MISUSE OF NAME IN CURRENT EVENTS IN YEMEN

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

The UAE's Ministry of Defence said yesterday that it has decided to end the remaining presence of its counter-terrorism teams in Yemen, citing recent developments and their potential impact on the safety and effectiveness of ongoing missions, WAM reported.

The announcement follows a statement issued earlier yesterday by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs addressing the current situation in Yemen and clarifying the facts surrounding the presence of the UAE Armed Forces in the country within the framework of the Arab Coalition in support of legitimacy.

In its statement, the Ministry of Defence reaffirmed that the UAE has participated in the Arab Coalition since 2015 in support of legitimacy in Yemen, in coordination with international efforts to combat terrorist organisations and to contribute to the security and stability of the brotherly Yemeni people. The ministry noted that Emirati personnel made significant sacrifices in pursuit of these objectives.

STABILITY FIRST

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, underscored the UAE's longstanding approach of placing wisdom above reaction and prioritising stability over the noise of escalation.

In a post on his official X account, Dr Gargash said: "The UAE's position once again reflects a commitment to calm judgement, responsible leadership and a clear preference for safeguarding regional stability at a time of heightened tensions."

The ministry further stated that the UAE concluded its military presence in Yemen in 2019 after completing the agreed missions within official frameworks, with any remaining presence limited to specialised teams operating as part of counter-terrorism efforts and in coordination with relevant international partners.

In light of recent developments and their potential implications for counter-terrorism operations, the Ministry of Defence said it had decided, of its own accord, to conclude the work of the remaining counter-terrorism teams in Yemen, while safeguarding the safety of its personnel and in coordination with concerned partners.

Comprehensive assessment

The ministry stressed that the decision is part of a comprehensive assessment of current requirements and is consistent with the UAE's commitments and its role in supporting security and stability in the region.

The UAE categorically rejects any attempt to involve its name in the tensions among Yemeni parties, and strongly denounces the allegations that it has exerted pressure on, or directed, any Yemeni party to carry out military operations that would undermine the security of the sisterly Kingdom of Saudi Arabia or target its borders. The UAE affirms its constant commitment to the security and stability of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, its full respect for the Kingdom's sovereignty and national security, and its rejection of any actions that may threaten the security of the Kingdom or the region.

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BUSINESS

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Governance of higher education overhauled

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

The UAE government has issued a federal decree law on higher education and scientific research, introducing a comprehensive legislative framework designed to strengthen governance across the sector, enhance quality and competitiveness, and better align educational outcomes with the evolving needs of the labour market.

Under the decree, national regulatory frameworks are set out for higher education and scientific research, including clear systems for licensing higher education institutions, implementing the National Qualifications Framework, and regulating classification, performance quality, and oversight. The law also formalises governance structures for scientific research and technical and vocational education and training.

Dh6,000 minimum wage for Emiratis in private sector

No application for Emirati work permit below Dh6,000 pay to be processed

The ministry clarified that the revised minimum wage applies to two-year Emirati work permits, whether newly issued, renewed, or amended.

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

The Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation has announced that the minimum wage for Emirati citizens working in the private sector will be raised to Dh6,000, effective January 1, as part of efforts to strengthen Emiratisation outcomes and improve job stability for nationals.

In a statement published on its digital platforms, the ministry said the revised minimum wage will apply to all services related to issuing, renewing, or amending work permits for Emirati employees in the private sector.

From the start of 2026, any application for an Emirati work permit that lists a salary below Dh6,000 will not be processed or issued.

The ministry said it will send automated notifications through its service channels and the MoHRE smart application to inform employers of the new requirement. Employers will be prompted to adjust salaries to meet the minimum threshold.

If an Emirati employee's salary is not updated by June 30, 2026, additional measures will come into effect from July 1, 2026, including the suspension of the employee's inclusion in Emiratisation calculations until the salary is corrected. Establishments will also face a restriction preventing the issuance of new work permits if Emirati salaries fall below the minimum requirement.

The ministry clarified that the revised minimum wage applies to two-year Emirati work permits, whether newly issued, renewed, or amended, and that salaries must not fall below Dh6,000 from the start of 2026.

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